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Response by Hon. Doreen Sioka, Minister of Gender Equality, Poverty Eradication and Social Welfare

Subject: Operation of Government Owned GBV shelters

Date: 10 October 2023

shelters stand as fortresses against this pervasive menace.

Moreover, the government continues to work closely with the private sector and NGOs in our relentless efforts. In total, we subsidize 18 Residential Child-Care facilities across 8 regions to the tune of N$2 million per year. The Ministry place children in need of care and protection in these facilities by court orders for care and protection, and these facilities play a vital role in ensuring the well-being of our most vulnerable children.

Thank you for your unwavering support, and we pledge to keep this esteemed Parliament apprised of our relentless progress in this vital matter.

is a pressing concern, it is crucial to understand that a single challenge should not overshadow the Ministry's broader work and its unwavering dedication to the well-being of our Namibian nation.

Addressing GBV is a multifaceted and long-term endeavour, and the Ministry is actively involved in initiatives aimed at resolving staffing issues and reinstating the government-owned shelters to full operation. We are determined to provide the necessary care and support to GBV survivors. In conclusion, let it be known that we take these challenges head-on with unwavering determination. The safety and welfare of our citizens are paramount, and we are fully committed to ensuring that our GBV

continue to provide crucial support under the care and supervision of social workers. There are 12 adults and 14 children accommodated in these shelters, offering them a safe haven from the hardships they face.

It's essential to note that these numbers exclude individuals accommodated in the two private shelters subsidized by the government. These private shelters contribute significantly to our ongoing efforts to support GBV survivors.

Furthermore, I want to emphasize that the Ministry of Gender Equality, Poverty Eradication, and Child Welfare remains committed to its mandate and responsibility. While the operational status of the shelters

Honorable Speaker, Honourable Members of Parliament,

I would like to address the issue regarding the operational status of government-owned gender-based violence (GBV) shelters in our nation. The recent reports have indicated that these shelters face significant challenges due to a shortage of staff, resulting in operational limitations. I would like to provide an update on the current situation and the actions being taken to address these concerns.

As of today's statistics, on October 10, 2023, there are individuals in the government-owned GBV shelters across the country. These figures reveal that while there are operational challenges, the shelters

I so submit Hon Speaker